Chapter Five

Common Types of Reports

Part 1

Chapter Five Outlines

5.1 Curriculum Vitae (CV)
5.2 Student Project Reports
5.3 Research Reports
5.4 Informative Reports
5.5 Explanatory Reports
5.6 Feasibility Reports
5.7 Annual Reports
5.8 Progress Reports
5.9 Appraisal Reports
5.10 Agenda for Committee Reports

Introduction

With each report type, We shall answer two questions:

1. What points should I bear in mind?

2. What would be a suitable format?

Use them flexibly; you must bear in mind:

- **The requirements of person ordered the report.**
- **House-style.**
- **Custom and conventions.**
- **Your objective(s).**
- **Your readership.**
- **Common sense.**

Curriculum Vitae

A **CV** (also known as a **Curriculum Vitae**, or **résumé**, which means "Course of Life" in ***Latin***)

There is no universally accepted format, but Your CV should cover these elements:

- **Personal Profile Statement**
- **Personal Statement**
- **Work Experience**
- **Education Qualification and Ongoing Personal Development**
- **Skills and Abilities**
- **Hobbies and Interests**
- **References**

Curriculum Vitae

Most CVs may include other information items, *such as* the following information:

- Academic history
- Professional experience
- Awards and honors
- Publications
- Professional associations
- Grants and fellowships
- Licenses and certificates
- Volunteer work

Curriculum Vitae

Things to watch out for

- Resist the need to jazz up your CV with images or colour.
- Steer clear of long paragraphs.
- Careful use of bold type can be effective, but don't overdo it.
- Underlining should be reserved for website links only.
- Use typefaces like 'Times New Roman' or 'Arial' - they're easier to read.
- Avoid using font sizes smaller than 11pt; employers won't strain their eyes to read it.
- Don't use txt speak and only use abbreviations if they're universally known.

Student Project Reports

What points should I bear in mind?

- Be aware of **who** will choose the topic. your professor, or by you, or through discussion between the two.
- The topic chosen must be acceptable to your examining group..
- Decide what sources of information you will require.
- Decide how you will gather this information.
- Gather the information.
- Analyze the information.
- Design and write the report.

Student Project Reports

What would be a suitable format?

1. Cover Page
2. Contents page
3. Introduction
4. Main body
5. Conclusions
6. Recommendations (where appropriate)
7. Appendixes
8. Sources/References

Beginning

Middle

End

Research Reports

What points should I bear in mind?

- Results alone are never enough.
- you must be able to assess and then evaluate the reliability of the results.
- You must say precisely how the work was carried out, what methods were used to collect the data, and how it was analyzed.
- Conclusions and recommendations must be drafted with great care.

Research Reports

What would be a suitable format?

Abstract

Introduction ... Work objectives - Adequate background

Literature Survey ...

Material and Methods ... ***Theory/Calculation***

Results ... **clear and concise.**

Discussion ... **The significance of work results.**

Conclusions/Future Work ... **The main deductions.**

Recommendations

References

Appendices

Informative Reports

The purpose is to increase the readers' knowledge of an event or to bring them up to date.

What points should I bear in mind?

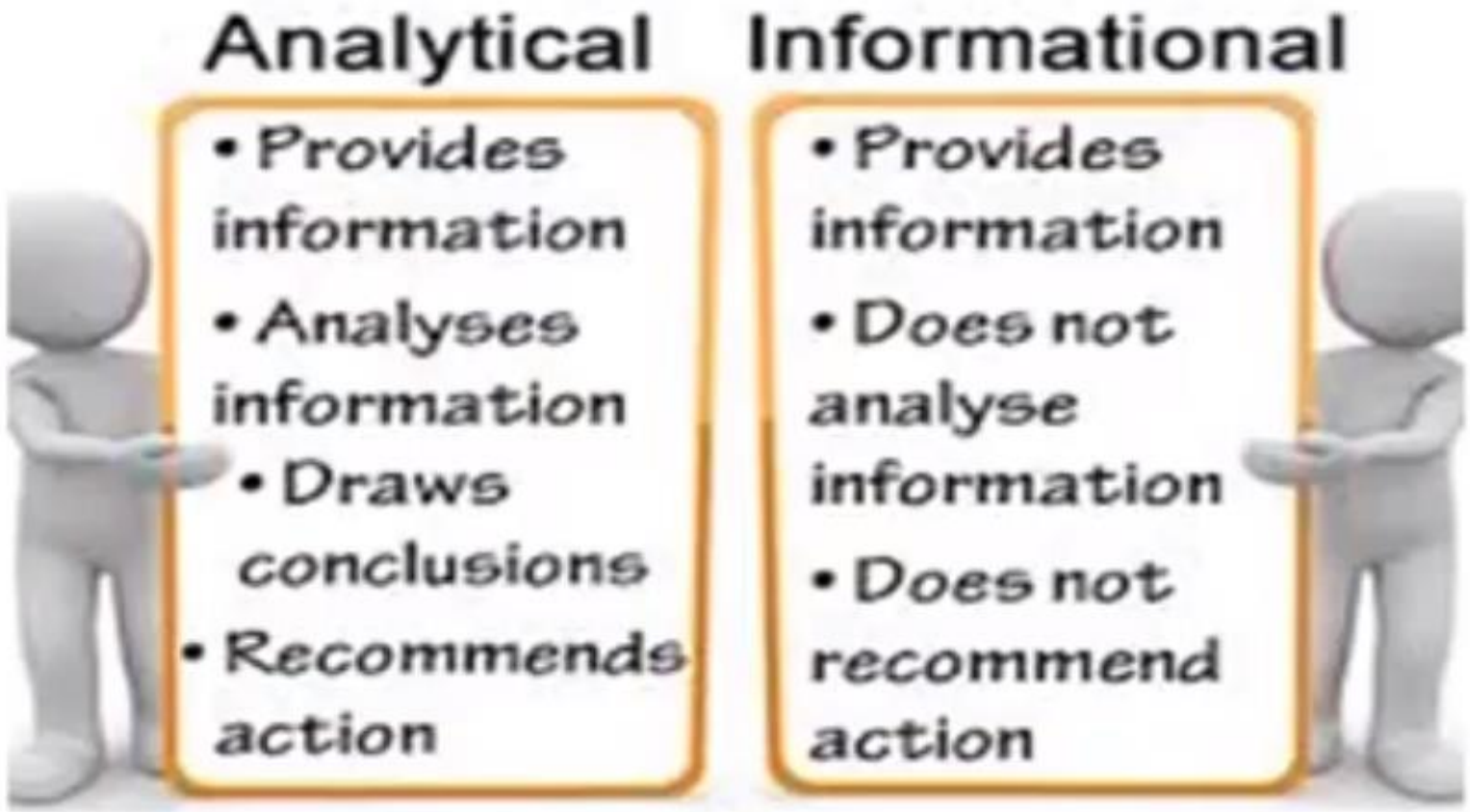
- You must present a clear overall theme.
- Each section must be appropriate to this theme; there must be a good reason for including it.
- It is important to provide a logical plan because some readers may be interested in perhaps just one or two sections of the report.

Informative Reports

What would be a suitable format?

1. Cover page and Contents page
2. Introduction (why was the report produced and what is hoped to be achieved by it?)
3. Plan (how the Main Body is structured)
4. Main Body (possibly one subsection for each main piece of information)
5. Conclusions (flowing naturally from the Main Body - also what, if anything, is it hoped will happen next?).

Informative Reports



Explanatory Reports

These are **factual reports** which provide an account (description or explanation) of something that has happened.

What points should I bear in mind?

- You must be unbiased and objective.
- Do not give any recommendations unless you are asked to do so.

Explanatory Reports

This is a suitable format for an explanatory report:

1. **Cover page**
2. **Contents page**
3. **Introduction**
   - Why was the report prepared, and who requested it?
   - Give a 'pen picture' of whatever has happened.
   - What is the position and authority of the writer?
4. **Persons involved** … Give their names and positions, where relevant.
5. **Sequence of events** … A simple, straightforward account of what happened.
6. **Action taken** … List all the critical actions taken in the order in which they occurred and the reasons for them. If necessary; use appendixes.
7. **Cause and Effect** … What were the causes and effects of these actions?
8. **Conclusions**
   - How was the information for the report gathered?
   - How long did this take?
   - What degree of accuracy can the reader reasonably assume?
   - Are any important facts omitted? - If so; why?
9. **Recommendations** … If required.
10. **Appendixes** … See section 5.

Feasibility Reports

- Discuss the practicality, and possibly the suitability and compatibility of a given project, both in physical and economic terms.
- Discuss the desirability of the proposed project from the viewpoint of those who would be affected by it.

Feasibility Reports

- Report writers must **come to a conclusion**, and must recommend that some action is taken or is not taken and/or that some choice is adopted or is rejected.

What points should I bear in mind?

- You must be unbiased and your approach must be logical.
- Be sure that you know the precise purpose of the proposed project and also its scope.

Feasibility Reports

What would be a suitable format?

This is a suitable format for a feasibility report:

1. Abstract
2. Summary
3. Contents list (including a separate list of illustrations)
4. Glossary
5. Introduction (purpose and scope)
6. Discussion (the main body providing the evidence - use appendixes if necessary)
7. Conclusions (flowing naturally from the discussion)
8. Recommendations (flowing naturally from the conclusions)
9. References (if necessary)
10. Appendixes (*see section 6*).

Sometimes sections 1 and 2 are combined.

Annual Reports

- Lists the achievements and failures of an organization.
- It is a progress report in which every department is accounted for every specific time periods (*for example*; yearly, monthly…etc.).

What points should I bear in mind?

- The physical appearance of annual reports is crucial.
- the **shorter** the report is the better the chances of attracting a border readership.
- Annual reports usually include a **chairperson's statement**.

Annual Reports

What would be a suitable format?

This depends on the nature of the organization and the readership. Here is one possible format:

- Contents list
- What the organization does
- Some of the year's highlights
- Chairperson's statement
- Main body (possibly department to department, or task to task)
- Accounts
- Appendixes.

Progress Reports

- **Periodic** reports describe how some activity or process is progressing.
- They are often built up from workers' daily logs, supervisors' reports, and so on.

What points should I bear in mind?

They will be required in one of 3 circumstances:

- **on a regular basis**
- **at certain times during an activity or process, *or***
- **as and when required.**

Progress Reports

What would be a suitable format?

Most organizations, departments, and projects have standard printed progress report forms, although headings vary considerably. Here is one simple format:

1. **Introduction**
   - The period of work covered
   - The work/activities planned
   - The authority for the work
   - The progress to date
2. **Main Body**
   - The work completed
   - How the work has been completed
   - The work planned for the future
   - An overall appraisal of the progress to date.

Appraisal Reports

Appraise a **person's performance** in his current job, identify methods of improving this performance, highlight **training needs**, and often assess **suitability** for another job, **promotion**, and/or a change in **salary**.

Appraisal reports are very important because what you write will have a direct effect on people's career prospects.

The responsibilities of an appraisal report writer, therefore, are **acute**.

Appraisal Reports

What would be a suitable format?

1. The Job

- The job description, its objectives, component tasks, methods and resources.
- Are they satisfactory?
- If not, why not?
- What changes are required?
- What action is recommended - by whom, how and why?

2. Job Performance

- What objectives must be met and what tasks must be fulfilled?
- Have these been achieved?
- What is the actual evidence from work performance, indicating success or failure?
- How far have any failures been within or outside the job-holder's control?
- What does the evidence of past performance show about the strengths and weaknesses in knowledge, skills and attitudes of the job-holder?
- What precise action is recommended - by whom, how and when - to build on strengths, to remedy weaknesses and to develop the individual by means of training and further work experience?

3. Summary of Action Proposed

- What action has been agreed to be taken by whom, how and when?

Agenda for Committee Reports

An agenda is a list of items to be discussed during a formal committee meeting. It *must* be drawn up in advance.

What points should I bear in mind?

An agenda may take various forms, according to the requirements and, in some cases, the kind of meeting to which it refers. Be sure you know precisely what is expected of you. Here are two common forms of committee agenda:

- The Standard Agenda
- The Discussion Agenda.

The Standard Agenda simply lists the subjects to be discussed, and the order in which they will be taken.

The Discussion Agenda is designed to stimulate thought *before* and comment *at* the meeting. It is often used for 'one-off' meetings.

Agenda for Committee Reports

Standard Agenda

A suitable format for a standard agenda would be as follows:

1. Heading (including where and when the meeting will take place)
2. Apologies for Absence
3. Minutes of the Previous Meeting
4.
5.
6.
7.

} **Items requiring the attention of the committee**

8. Any Other Business ('leftovers', not items that should have been discussed within section 4-7)
9. Date of Next Meeting (also give the time and location)
10. Papers required for the Meeting (in the order that they will be needed).

Items 1-3 and 8-10 are standard. Between them come all other items requiring the attention of the committee.

Agenda for Committee Reports

Discussion Agenda

A **discussion agenda could be structured as follows:**

1. **Heading** (including where and when the meeting will take place)
2. **Introduction** (what will be discussed, and why - keep it fairly general)
3. **Scope** (what are the boundaries of the discussion?)
4. **Discussion points** (list the items to be discussed and the reasons for discussing them)
5. **Possible action** (what options are open to the committee?)
6. **Summary** (the reason for the meeting; what it hopes to achieve and why members should attend and contribute)
7. **Papers required for the meeting** (in the order that they will be needed).

Chapter Five

Common Types of Reports

Part 2

Chapter Five Outlines

5.11 Minutes Reports
5.12 Interview Reports
5.13 Scientific Reports
5.14 Systems Evaluation Reports
5.15 Technical Reports
5.16 Technological Reports
5.17 Process Description Reports
5.18 Instructional Manuals
5.19 Comparative Testing Reports
5.20 Audit Reports

Introduction

With each report type, We shall answer two questions:

1. What points should I bear in mind?

2. What would be a suitable format?

5.11 Minutes Reports

A written record of the business transacted at a meeting.

What points should I bear in mind?

The **fewer** the words used the better. The **purpose** of meeting? **Decisions** taken, **Motions** passed and **names** of people attended. A **standing committee** provide enough information and discussion ***for*** absent members

- Keep its **parent committee** in touch with developments and to explain the reasons for decisions.

5.11 Minutes Reports

What would be a suitable format?

1. **Heading** (including where and when the meeting was held)
2. **Present** (who was there)
3. **Apologies for Absence** (who should have been there, but was not)
4. **Minutes of the Previous Meeting** (note any corrections and state 'The minutes were accepted as a true record of the meeting [with the above corrections]')
5.
6.
7.
8.

Simple statements of what actually occurred at the meeting

9. Any Other Business (the 'leftovers')
10. Date of Next Meeting (also give the time and location).

Example in the book

5.12 Interview Reports

What points should I bear in mind?

- **Clear and adequate reports.**
- **A detailed and accurate recall and evaluation of interviewees (Job Applicants).**

There are two types of interview report.

The first to ensure that an interview is well-structured, comprehensive, and that adequate and relevant notes are taken.

The second to evaluate the material gathered during the interview.

5.12 Interview Reports

What would be a suitable format?

A Structured Interview Report

1. **Interviewee, interviewer, reference, date, time and location**
2. **Physical**:
   - First impression
   - Appearance
   - Speech
   - Health
3. **Attainments**:
   - Work
   - Educational
   - Extramural
4. **Interests**
5. **Circumstances**:
   - Family background
   - Domestic and social situation
6. **Special abilities**
7. **General intelligence**
8. **Personality.**

5.12 Interview Reports

What would be a suitable format?

An Interview Evaluation Summary Report

1. **Interviewee**, **interviewer**, **reference**, **date**, **time** and **location**
2. **Able to do**
3. **Willing to do**: Character, Motivation … etc.
4. **Summary**
5. **Recommendation**.

5.13 Scientific Reports

A scientific report consists of an account of a test or scientific experiment, **computer software**, of its findings, and of its conclusions.

What points should I bear in mind?

Before you can write the report, You must carry out the **test** or **experiment** accurately and record your **results** as you proceed.

5.13 Scientific Reports

What would be a suitable format?

1- Cover Page.
2- Title Of Experiment.
3- Summary.
4- Contents Page.
5- Introduction.
6- Apparatus.
7- Circuit Theory.
8- Method.
9- Results.
10- Conclusions.
11- Appendixes.

5.14 Systems Evaluation Reports

It serves one of 3 Purposes

1- To discover which software, hardware, system out of several alternatives.

2- To test a device, hardware or system.

3- To investigate into causes of failures in an operational system.

5.14 Systems Evaluation Reports

What Points should I bear in mind?

The purpose of the first two types of report is to inform those concerned with selection, implementation and utilization about:

- The requirements of the application
- The criteria by which the systems should be judged
- The features of available systems
- Data on their performance in the field *and*
- Recommendations or conclusions about the best course of action.

5.14 Systems Evaluation Reports

What would be a suitable Format?

A suitable format for a report with the purpose of discovering which system out of several alternatives is most suitable for a particular application is as follows:

1. **Cover page, Contents page**
2. **Preface** (***Personal Background***: why have you written the report?)
3. **System Requirements**
4. **Systems Available**
5. **Criteria for Selection**
6. **The Final Choice**
7. **Appendixes** (System Data Sheets).

5.15 Technical Reports

Written at an early stage in a production process. They are usually generated internally, either by **the technical publications department** of an organization or by **staff involved in production process**.

Here are some examples of technical reports:

- **Computer Software**
- **A technical proposal**
- **A feasibility study**
- **Design and research reports**
- **Pre-production reports**
- **Evaluation documents**
- **Ad hoc reports.**

5.17 Process Description Reports

A process is a specific series of consecutive actions/activities that bring about a specific result.

What points should I bear in mind?

Instructional Manuals… explain *how* a process is to be performed;

Process Description Reports... help the reader *understand* that process.

They are used to describe the following:

- how something is made
- how something is done (for information, not instruction)
- how a mechanism works
- how a natural process occurs.

5.17 Process Description Reports

What would be a suitable format?

1. **Cover page**
2. **Contents page** (with a separate list of illustrations)
3. **Introduction** (identifies the process; record its purpose and significance; give an overview of the steps involved)
4. **Main body** (discuss each step in turn)
5. **Summary** (concentrate on the purpose and importance of the actions or the significance of the facts).

5.18 Instructional Manuals

Duty Notes reports are usually written to explain how a job, software, program or process (or perhaps how a particular aspect) is to be performed.

What points should I bear in mind?

- Written by people who know the job or process well.
- They know how much detailed instruction to include, and how much to leave out.
- Once you have drafted your instructions, try them out first on someone who is likely to use the report.

5.18 Instructional Manuals

What would be a suitable format?

1. **Contents page**
2. **Job/Duty/Process objective** (a brief statement of subject, purpose and scope)
3. **Theory or principles of the operation** (the mechanics of the process)
4. **List of materials and equipment needed**
5. **Description of the mechanism** (an overview of the equipment, possibly breaking it into its component parts)
6. **List and number of steps necessary to complete the job**
7. **Instructions for each step** (the main body)
8. **Precautions necessary** (explain why) وسائل الأمن والسلامة المطلوبة
9. **Show what must be done** (use illustrations to support section 7)
10. **The degree of difficulty at each stage.**

Sections **3-5** and **8** are often omitted from **clerical duty notes**.

5.19 Comparative Testing Reports

The best known of comparative testing/evaluation reports is **which choice is the best?** *For example*; computer devices, software packages, hardware systems … etc.

What points should I bear in mind?

It is essential to choose ***sensible*** **standards** (**appropriate criteria**) and then to define them very carefully at the report beginning.

5.19 Comparative Testing Reports

What would be a suitable format?

The first is to define the first **standard** and then compare the performance of **each item** before moving on to the next standard.

The second is to name the first **item** and then record how it matches up to various **standards**, before moving on to the next item.

5.20 Audit Reports

What points should I bear in mind?

The External Auditor commits himself to a high degree of responsibility.

reflect an opinion within the limits of the examination, and sufficiently clear as to leave no likelihood of misinterpretation by those whom it concerns.

The Internal Auditor the report is not written for the same audience - it is for **internal consumption**.

It must always strive for **objectivity** and **accuracy**.

5.20 Audit Reports

What would be a suitable format?

The usual format for **An External Audit Report** on the financial statements of a company incorporated in Great Britain is as follows:

1. **Introduction**
2. **Respective responsibilities of directors and auditors**
3. **Basis of opinion**
4. **Opinion.**

5.20 Audit Reports

What would be a suitable format?

A suitable format for An Internal Audit Report may be as follows:

1. **Cover and Contents page**
2. **Summary** … (the main findings, conclusions and recommendations)
3. **Introduction** … (what broad subjects were audited, where and when)
4. **Scope** … (what precisely was audited, and possibly what was not)
5. **Main body** … (the findings, divided into logical sub-sections)
6. **Conclusions** … (flowing naturally from the main body)
7. **Recommendations** … (flowing naturally from the conclusions)
8. **Appendixes.**